



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Tell it like it is!



Learning Outcome

Describe hypothetical situations in written and spoken interactions according to work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Do you have a friend that you don't see as much as you used to? What happened?
- Do you usually discuss your relationship and feelings? Why or why not?

Can Do Statements

- I can write about emotions, personal qualities and behavior.
- I can write about how to react to things going wrong.
- I can write a short e-mail.





Let's Explore!

Vanessa is frustrated and **perplexed** *by Peter's recent behavior. She writes him an e-mail to express her feelings.

* "Perplexed" means completely puzzled.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Subject Line: Time to talk ...

Dear Peter,

You and I have been close friends for years. Some have said that we were more like siblings than buddies. I cherish your friendship and the memories we have shared. However, I feel that you might be pulling away from the group. You seem distant, cold and to be honest ... a little self absorbed. The last time I saw you, you spent most of the time on your cell phone, complaining about your workload or fixing your hair.

Sally said that you had declined the invitation to throw axes on Sunday because you had so much work to do. She also intimated that you had thought axe throwing was a silly idea. Later, a friend of mine told me that she had seen you having drinks at a bistro downtown. I thought that it might have been a case of mistaken identity until she described your favorite T-shirt. I felt quite betrayed and am hoping that it is just a huge misunderstanding. Friendship is a matter of trust, isn't it?

If you preferred to to do something else or spend time with others you should have told me. I was hurt and insulted when I realized I had been lied to. We've always been able to be honest with each other, haven't we? I realize that relationships have their ups and downs. It's not always smooth sailing. However, I don't want us to be like two ships passing in the night. Do you? I care about you too much. Our friendship is worth fighting for, isn't it?

Your disheartened friend,

Vanessa





Let's Practice!

Vanessa doesn't feel well. What did she say in the letter?

Instructions: Read the sentences. Select the correct answer for each case.

1. When Vanessa says that relationships have ups and downs, she means that:

- ☐ there are good and bad times
- ☐ people have to go up and down
- ☐ some people are better than others
- ☐ there is always a person that wins
- ☐ she is the best

2. "Smooth sailing" means that:

- ☐ sailing is good
- ☐ sailing is an option
- ☐ things are calm
- ☐ people are in silence
- ☐ things are hectic



Let's Practice!

Can you complete these sentences?

Instructions: Write the missing words. Choose from: are more siblings than, had seen, declined the invitation to, intimidated, and haven't we. Practice saying the sentences aloud. Compare your pronunciation to a partner's. Correct each other.

1. People say that Vanessa and Peter _____ buddies.
2. A friend of Vanessa told her that she _____ Peter having drinks.
3. Sally said that Peter had _____ to throw axes.
4. Sally _____ that Peter had thought axe throwing was a silly idea.
5. We've always been able to be honest with each other, _____?





Extension Activity

We had a falling-out!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- In pairs, brainstorm all the reasons people have a falling-out with friends.
- Create a role play where two friends have a falling-out.
- The dialogue should be at least 3 minutes long.
- Set the scene and use tag questions to clarify information.
- At the end of the role play, have your classmates offer advice on how to possibly resolve the argument.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I brainstorm situations which people have conflicts.

☐ ☐

I role play a dialogue with a partner.

☐ ☐

I ask for clarification.

☐ ☐

I give advice to classmates to help resolve conflicts.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **ships that pass in the night** (expression): people who meet once or twice by chance for a short time then do not see each other again
e.g. I don't want us to be like two ships passing in the night. Do you?
- **mistaken identity** (noun): an error about who someone is
e.g. I thought that it might have been a case of mistaken identity
- **workload** (noun): the amount of work assigned to or expected from a worker in a specified time period
e.g. You spent most of the time on your cell phone, complaining about your workload.
- **to cherish** (verb): to remember or hold an idea, belief, etc in a deeply felt way
e.g. I cherish our friendship and the memories we have shared.
- **to intimate** (verb): to suggest indirectly; to hint
e.g. She also intimated that you had thought axe throwing was a silly idea.





Learning Points

Reported Speech and Questions

You use *reported speech* when you are saying (reporting) what other people said.

When you tell people what someone has said in the past, you generally make the verb tense 'more in the past'. You need to change the verb to the next past form.

For example:

Direct speech	Reported speech
"I like him."	He said he liked him.
"I'm coming to the party."	He said he was coming .
"I already ate ."	He told me he had already eaten .
"Where do you live ?"	He asked me where I lived .

You have to change the pronoun when you report what another person said. Compare these two sentences. In each case the person actually said "I don't want to go."

- I said, "I don't want to go." > I said **I** didn't want to go.
- Bill said, "I don't want to go." > Bill said **he** didn't want to go.

Ask is a verb you can use to introduce a reported question. Here are some examples:

The vet **asked** (me) **if/whether...** (YES/NO questions)

The nurse **asked** (me) **why/when/where/what/how...**

(question-word questions)

Look carefully at your reported question, as you may not only need to change pronouns and tense but time and place as well.

The word order is the same as in a normal statement.

(subject-verb-object)





Learning Points

Look at the chart below to see the changes in verb tense.

Direct speech	Reported speech
Simple Present	Simple Past
Present Progressive	Past Progressive
Simple Past	Past Perfect
Present Perfect	Past Perfect
Past Progressive	Past Perfect Progressive
Future Simple (will)	Conditional (would)
Modal Can	Modal Could
Modal May	Modal Might
Modal Will	Modal Would

Examples:

- *Sally said that you had declined the invitation to throw axes on Sunday because you had so much work to do.*
- *She also intimated that you had thought axe throwing was a silly idea.*
- *Later, a friend of mine told me that she had seen you having drinks at a bistro downtown.*





Learning Points

Tag Questions

A *tag question* is a statement that is followed by a mini-question. You use a tag question to ask for confirmation.

Tag questions are used to mean "Do you agree?" or "Is that right?"

The basic structure is:

positive statement	negative tag
Your project is due tomorrow,	isn't it?
negative statement	positive tag
You're not interested in leaving,	are you?

The tag repeats the auxiliary verb (or main verb when *be*) from the statement and changes it to negative or positive.

Examples:

- *Our friendship is worth fighting for, isn't it?*
- *We've always been able to be honest with each other, haven't we?*

